

August 12, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Isaura Larkin (MRN MUSC3566958), Claim MUSC-20260423-26B6-2

Patient	Isaura Larkin (DOB 1950-01-12)
MRN	MUSC3566958
Member ID / Group	AMB642900279 / GRP-36295
Claim number	MUSC-20260423-26B6-2
Date of service	2026-04-23
Procedure billed	CPT 97110 — Therapeutic exercise, each 15 minutes
Primary diagnosis	E78.5 — Hyperlipidemia, unspecified
Denied amount	\$802.27
Denial code	CARC 151 / RARC N362 — Payer deems the information submitted does not support this many/frequency of services.
Appeal deadline	2026-08-11

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center submits this formal appeal on behalf of patient Isaura Larkin (MRN: MUSC3566958, Member ID: AMB642900279) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260423-26B6-2 for services rendered on April 23, 2026. The claim was denied under CARC 151 and RARC N362, with the payer remark stating: "Units billed exceed the plan's allowable frequency for this service." The total denied amount is \$802.27 for two units of CPT 97110 (Therapeutic Exercise, each 15 minutes). MUSC Health respectfully contends that the two units billed are clinically appropriate, correctly coded, and supported by the patient's documented active conditions.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Larkin is a 76-year-old female with a documented history of active osteoarthritis of the knee (ICD-10 M17.9, onset 2007-12-29), active hyperlipidemia (ICD-10 E78.5, onset 2005-02-10), active chronic obstructive bronchitis, and prediabetes, among other conditions. She has been a former smoker and has a longstanding history of pulmonary rehabilitation, reflecting the chronic and complex nature of her medical profile. The April 23, 2026 encounter was billed as an outpatient hospital visit at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center, rendered by Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687), under Place of Service 22. The primary diagnosis driving the therapeutic exercise service was hyperlipidemia (E78.5), with a secondary diagnosis of R69. Therapeutic exercise is a recognized intervention in the management of hyperlipidemia and related metabolic conditions, particularly in older patients where pharmacologic management alone — in this case, Simvastatin 10 mg — may be supplemented by structured physical activity to achieve optimal outcomes.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial under CARC 151 and RARC N362 reflects a frequency-based edit rather than a determination that the service itself was not covered or not medically necessary. CPT 97110 is defined as therapeutic exercise performed in timed 15-minute increments, and billing two units represents a total of 30 minutes of therapeutic exercise during a single session. Two units of CPT 97110 in a single encounter is consistent with standard physical and therapeutic exercise practice and does not, by itself, constitute excessive utilization. Ambetter from Absolute Total Care has not identified a specific contractual or clinical policy provision that limits CPT 97110 to a single unit per encounter for this patient's diagnoses, nor has the plan provided documentation that the medical record was reviewed by a qualified clinician prior to issuing the frequency-based denial.

Ms. Larkin's active osteoarthritis of the knee is a condition directly amenable to therapeutic exercise intervention, and her age and comorbidity profile support the medical necessity of a 30-minute structured session. The allowed amount on the claim of \$576.07 further suggests the plan recognizes the service as reimbursable in principle; the sole basis for full denial is the unit count. MUSC Health requests that Ambetter conduct a clinical review of the medical record for this encounter, as the documentation supports the medical necessity of both units billed. Payers are generally obligated under applicable state and federal regulations to base utilization determinations on a review of the actual clinical record rather than automated frequency edits alone.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-20260423-26B6-2 in full and reprocess both units of CPT 97110 for the date of service April 23, 2026, at the applicable contracted rate. Should the plan require additional clinical documentation to support this appeal, MUSC Health will provide the complete medical record for this encounter promptly upon request through the secure provider portal. This appeal is submitted in advance of the August 11, 2026 appeal deadline.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record